ii. Trade related Entrepreneruship Assistance and Development (TREAD) Scheme for Women

iii. Mahila Coir Yojana

iv. Mahila E-haat

v. Magalir Udavi Scheme

vi. Prime Minister's RozgarYojana (PMRY)

vii. Development of Women and Children in Rural India (DWCRA)

viii. Mudra Yojana Scheme for Women

ix. Udyogini Scheme

x. TRYCEM

## VI. Opportunities Created through Training Programme

Government of India has introduced National Skill Development Policy and National Skill Development Mission in 2009 in order to provide skill training, vocational education and entrepreneurship development to the emerging work force. This has been catalysing the emergence of women entrepreneurs in India. The following training schemes are being implemented for promoting self employment of women by Government of India.

1. Support for Training and Employment Programme of Women (STEP)
2. Development of Women and Children in Rural Areas (DWCRA)
3. Small Industry Service Institutes
4. State Financial Corporations
5. National Small Industries Corporations
6. District Industrial Centres

## VII. Consortium of Women Entrepreneurs of India (CWEI)

Consortium of Women Entrepreneurs of India (CWEI) was registered as a civil society in the year 1996 which is a non-profit organisation in New Delhi. It is accredited by Government of India. It is a member of National Board, Ministry of MSME and is working closely with Ministry of Rural Development in the Public Private Partnership to support below poverty line families in India. They are rendering the following functions:

i. They are acting as a springboard for enterprises started by the women.
ii. It is helping women achieve high economic empowerment.
iii. It is acting as a catalyst to improve the access of womenfolk to natural resources.
iv. It is providing technological support in the sphere of product design and development in the case of women owned enterprises.
v. It is providing quality control, marketing and technological supports to women owned enterprises.
vi. It is spreading knowledge to women entrepreneurs about various government schemes.

In sum, it can be stated that women consortium is an agency providing a comprehensive service of various types to women owned enterprises.

## Challenges of Women Entrepreneurs

Though there is a tremendous growth in the women entrepreneurship in India, a number of research studies conducted in India have brought out the following problems and challenges encountered by women entrepreneurs during the course of their entrepreneurial journey.

### 1. Problem of Finance

The access of women to external sources of funds is limited as they do not generally own properties in their own name. Financial institutions too do not consider women in general creditworthy as they are sceptical of their entrepreneurial capabilities of women. They impose stringent condition which discourages women to avail themselves of loan assistance from banks. In this context, they are pushed to rely on their own savings and small loans from friends and relatives. Because of the limited



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